

Lab: The Backward Memory

Goal

Feel how hard it is to learn a new way of moving -- and watch your brain rewire itself!

What You Need

- Paper and a pencil
- A mirror (bathroom mirror or handheld)
- A table to set up on

Steps

1. The Easy Way

Look at your paper normally. Draw a simple star shape. Easy, right? Your brain has a strong, well-worn path for this movement.

2. The Setup

Now set up the mirror challenge. Place your paper on the table in front of the mirror. Hold a book or folder above your hand so you CANNOT see your hand directly -- you can only see it in the mirror.

3. The Hard Way

Try to trace the star shape (or draw a new one) while ONLY looking in the mirror. Your brain says "Move right!" but in the mirror, your hand goes LEFT! It feels wobbly, strange, and frustrating. That is totally normal.

4. Keep Trying

Practice for 2-3 minutes. Does it get any easier? Each time you try, your brain is building a new path. The more you practice, the smoother it gets.

5. Compare

Look at your first attempt and your last attempt. Can you see improvement? That is your brain learning!

My Learning Log

*

Write your response here

* My first mirror star looked like: ____ My last mirror star looked like: ____ The hardest part was: ____

Attempt	How Did It Look?	How Did It Feel?
Normal Star		
Mirror Star (1st try)		
Mirror Star (3rd try)		
Mirror Star (5th try)		

What We Learned

Question	My Answer
Did the mirror star get better with practice?	
Why was it so hard at first?	
What did your brain have to relearn?	